

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-A2: Vulgate Texture and Biblical Idiom

Describe recurring biblical texture, compare exact source and liturgical adaptation, and distinguish grammatical pattern from claims of source-language influence

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

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Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-A2
Course stage	Stage IV — Advanced Reading and Composition
Prerequisites	EL-A1 and evidence-scaled register description
Observable outcome	Describe recurring biblical texture, compare exact source and liturgical adaptation, and distinguish grammatical pattern from claims of source-language influence
Printed practice	Worksheets IV.6 (source and adaptation, Variant B) and IV.8 (direct biblical reading, Variant D), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets IV.5 and IV.7 remain optional parataxis and pattern-imitation practice
Next dependency	EL-A3, Allusion, Context, and Typology

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Build a source/adaptation morphology ledger and complete Worksheet IV.6.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Apply direct biblical reading and discourse analysis in Worksheet IV.8, then audit every proposed influence claim.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: Compare a Missal adaptation with its identified biblical source, account for every grammatical change, describe recurring texture without calling it ungrammatical, and make no source-language claim without an actual source comparison.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- texture, discourse frequency, event formula, cognate expression, and genitive chain;
- repeated coordination whose local relation must be inferred cautiously;
- exact overlap, morphological adaptation, and contextual change; and
- observable Latin pattern versus supported source-language influence.

2.2 High-risk contrast

Calling a pattern biblical describes distribution in an identified corpus. Calling it a source-language calque explains its history and therefore requires comparison with the source language or a checked scholarly locus.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

A2. Vulgate texture and biblical idiom

Liturgical texts quote, adapt, and echo the Vulgate. Direct familiarity with its habits prevents the reader from “correcting” meaningful scriptural texture into a more Ciceronian shape.

Texture is the cumulative linguistic character produced by recurrent choices in wording, clause linkage, formula, and rhythm on the page. A **biblical idiom** is a recurrent scriptural expression or construction, sometimes encouraged by Hebrew or Greek; it remains describable Latin and is not a label for whatever seems unfamiliar. **Source-language influence** is a historical explanation supported by comparison with the source, not an inference licensed by unusual Latin alone.

On completing this unit, you can:

- recognize recurrent parataxis, formula, and source-language influence;
- distinguish a grammatical construction from its discourse frequency;
- compare a Missal adaptation with its biblical source; and
- imitate a biblical pattern without turning it into a universal rule.

1.1 Recurring textures

The table names patterns rather than exceptions to grammar. **Discourse frequency** means how often or characteristically a construction occurs in a kind of discourse; it must be distinguished from whether that construction is grammatical at all. An **event formula** is a recurrent frame that presents or advances an event. A **cognate expression** places words from the same root family in one construction. A **genitive chain** is a sequence of two or more genitives whose head relations must be established one by one, not assumed to form a single undifferentiated modifier.

Texture	Typical signal	Reading task
Parataxis	repeated <i>et</i> , finite clauses in sequence	determine the logical relation from context rather than assuming every <i>et</i> means exactly the same English connector
Event formula	<i>factum est</i> + clause or temporal phrase	separate the narrative frame from the event; note possible biblical source pattern
Presentation	<i>ecce</i>	identify what is brought into discourse and whether a finite verb is supplied
Cognate expression	related noun and verb	explain emphasis or inherited idiom rather than avoiding repetition in analysis
Genitive chain	several nouns linked by genitive	find each head and avoid reversing relations in polished English
Abstract-for-concrete or collective expression	<i>caro, semen, domus</i>	establish sense from biblical context

Texture	Typical signal	Reading task
Formulaic response	<i>amen, alleluia, hosanna</i>	recognize that not all liturgical words are Latin or should be forced into a Latin paradigm

Worked example: a source adapted in the Ordinary

Worked passage ID: W.IV.2; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Matthew 8:8 reads: *Domine, non sum dignus ut intres sub tectum meum: sed tantum dic verbo, et sanabitur puer meus*. The Communion preparation replaces *puer meus* with *anima mea*. Grammar remains stable: *dignus* is completed by an *ut*-clause with present subjunctive *intres*; *dic* is imperative; *verbo* is ablative of means; *sanabitur* is future passive. The adaptation transfers the centurion's trust to the communicant's soul. The allusion is more than shared vocabulary: the altered final noun depends on the whole remembered scene.

Worked example: from psalm to altar prayer

Worked passage ID: W.IV.3; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Et introibo ad altare Dei: ad Deum qui lætificat iuventutem meam (Psalm 42:4) first expresses motion toward *altare*; the second *ad*-phrase, *ad Deum*, clarifies that goal epexegetically. The relative *qui* is nominative subject of *lætificat*; *iuventutem* is its object; *meam* agrees with that object. Direct reading retains the forward movement and relative identification before seeking elegant English.

1.2 Controlled imitation

Imitation is composition that preserves specified, observable features of a model while changing its content. It is **controlled** when the model, the features to preserve, and the permissible changes are stated in advance. It differs from translation, which transfers the sense of a supplied text, and from patchwriting, which joins borrowed phrases without governing them through an independently planned structure.

Imitate a pattern, not its accidental vocabulary. For *Cor mundum crea in me, Deus, et spiritum rectum innova in visceribus meis* (Psalm 50:12), preserve:

- object + adjective before an imperative;
- a prepositional phrase of location;
- vocative address; and
- a coordinated second petition.

Write a new sentence with supplied nouns and verbs, then mark where imitation ends. Do not present an exercise sentence as a liturgical text.

Advance when: compare three short Missal texts with their Vulgate sources, identify exact quotation, adaptation, and broader echo, explain the grammar of both versions, and write one controlled imitation whose source pattern is explicitly documented.

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 Recurring textures — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Texture emerges from repeated observable choices, not from one unfamiliar-looking construction.

Transfer task. For three examples already printed in the lesson, record the repeated signal, full grammatical parse, local discourse relation, and what broader claim remains unproved.

Retrieval check. Distinguish grammaticality from discourse frequency.

1.2 Controlled imitation — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Imitation tests whether the learner can preserve a visible pattern while changing the proposition and labeling the result as project composition.

Transfer task. Choose one lesson pattern, state its invariant frame, and write two project-composed Latin sentences with new content; then audit every changed case, person, and agreement.

Retrieval check. Name the invariant before comparing vocabulary.

Part IV

Selected Practice

CHAPTER 1

A2 worksheet family: Vulgate texture

A2-B — Source and adaptation**Worksheet ID:** IV.6**Focus:** Account for every grammatical change.**Use:** Use with a Bible and Missal, not a facing translation.

1. **Text:** *Domine, non sum dignus ut intres sub tectum meum: sed tantum dic verbo, et sanabitur puer meus.*

Passage ID: IV.6.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse *dignus, ut intres, verbo, sanabitur, puer meus.*

-
2. Record the Ordinary's adaptation and the required agreement.

-
3. What wider narrative fact is activated beyond the shared words?

-
4. **Text:** *Sanctus, Sanctus, Sanctus Dominus Deus Sabaoth. Pleni sunt cæli et terra gloria tua.*

Passage ID: IV.6.2; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Compare the agreement in *pleni sunt* with Isaiah's *plena est omnis terra*.

-
5. Why must an allusion note mention the shift from *eius* to *tua*?
-

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction's rule.

A2-D — Direct biblical reading**Worksheet ID:** IV.8**Focus:** Understand before rendering.**Use:** Use as an unseen gate for A2.

1. **Text:** *In principio erat Verbum, et Verbum erat apud Deum, et Deus erat Verbum.*

Passage ID: IV.8.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Map subjects, predicates, and prepositional phrase; explain why order matters.

-
2. Explain *apud* + *accusative* here without reducing it to one English preposition.

-
3. Identify the repeated rhetorical element.

-
4. Write a two-sentence Latin paraphrase using simpler order but preserving the claims.

-
5. Without translating line by line, write an English paragraph explaining what grammatical decisions a reader must make.
-

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction's rule.

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

Recurring textures — model and rubric

Connection. Texture emerges from repeated observable choices, not from one unfamiliar-looking construction.

Model / acceptable evidence. Each model row parses ordinary Latin first, then records recurrence. Frequency can characterize a corpus even when the construction is grammatical elsewhere; one occurrence cannot prove source influence.

Controlled imitation — model and rubric

Connection. Imitation tests whether the learner can preserve a visible pattern while changing the proposition and labeling the result as project composition.

Model / acceptable evidence. A passing model explicitly labels the Latin project-composed, preserves the declared syntax or discourse frame, changes the proposition, and accounts for every morphological cascade. Mere synonym substitution does not pass.

CHAPTER 3

Selected worksheet solutions

CHAPTER 4

A2 worksheet family: Vulgate texture

A2-B — Source and adaptation

Worksheet ID: IV.6

Focus: Account for every grammatical change.

Use: Use with a Bible and Missal, not a facing translation.

- Text:** *Domine, non sum dignus ut intres sub tectum meum: sed tantum dic verbo, et sanabitur puer meus.*
Passage ID: IV.6.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse *dignus, ut intres, verbo, sanabitur, puer meus*.
Answer / notes: *dignus* nominative predicate; *intres* present active subjunctive 2 singular in a clause complementing/respecting worthiness; *verbo* ablative means; *sanabitur* future passive; *puer meus* nominative subject.
- Record the Ordinary's adaptation and the required agreement.
Answer / model: It substitutes *anima mea* for *puer meus*; both new forms are nominative singular feminine, while *sanabitur* remains 3 singular.
- What wider narrative fact is activated beyond the shared words?
Answer / model: The centurion trusts Christ's authority to heal by a word despite unworthiness; the communicant applies that trust and unworthiness to the soul.
- Text:** *Sanctus, Sanctus, Sanctus Dominus Deus Sabaoth. Pleni sunt cæli et terra gloria tua.*
Passage ID: IV.6.2; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Compare the agreement in *pleni sunt* with Isaiah's *plena est omnis terra*.
Answer / notes: In the Mass, plural *sunt* responds to the compound subject *cæli et terra*; masculine plural *pleni* uses allowed nearest-noun gender agreement with adjacent masculine *cæli*. In Isaiah, feminine singular *plena* and singular *est* agree with *omnis terra*.
- Why must an allusion note mention the shift from *eius* to *tua*?
Answer / model: It changes third-person reference to direct second-person address, adapting the scriptural acclamation to the liturgical utterance.

A2-D — Direct biblical reading

Worksheet ID: IV.8

Focus: Understand before rendering.

Use: Use as an unseen gate for A2.

- Text:** *In principio erat Verbum, et Verbum erat apud Deum, et Deus erat Verbum.*
Passage ID: IV.8.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Map subjects, predicates, and prepositional phrase; explain why order matters.
Answer / notes: First: *Verbum* is subject with *erat*; second: *Verbum* is subject with *apud Deum*. In the third clause both *Deus* and *Verbum* are nominative, so morphology alone cannot distinguish subject from predicate. Prior discourse and the source's progression support continuing *Verbum* as subject and fronted *Deus* as predicate nominative; proximity alone does not decide.
- Explain *apud* + accusative here without reducing it to one English preposition.
Answer / model: It expresses presence/relationship "with/in the presence of" God; dictionary sense must fit Johannine context.
- Identify the repeated rhetorical element.
Answer / model: Lexical repetition of *Verbum*, including anadiplosis across the first two clauses, together with repeated *erat* and *et*-coordination.
- Write a two-sentence Latin paraphrase using simpler order but preserving the claims.
Answer / model: Model: *Verbum in principio erat. Verbum apud Deum erat, et Verbum Deus erat.*
- Without translating line by line, write an English paragraph explaining what grammatical decisions a reader must make.
Answer / model: The answer must address predicate nominative versus subject, repeated imperfect *erat*, *apud* government, and the effect of fronted *Deus*; a doctrinal summary without grammar is insufficient.

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-A2, *Vulgate Texture and Biblical Idiom*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. The packet compares already identified course texts; it does not independently establish Hebrew or Greek influence.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source

roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T21:32:44Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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